WOLVERINE

PERCY
EATON
MAYER
JUNIOR
WILSON

MARVEL

12

LGY#354

PARENTAL ADVISORY

Paris is the city of lights, Logan...

...but I feel as though I am living in the *pēnombre*.

I don't know if you're talking fancy or dirty to me.

The penumbra. The shadow space between true darkness and light.

Not quite human, not quite vampire.

You know what I wish?

What do you wish?

I wish I could pluck up the Eiffel Tower...

...and ram it right through my own heart.

Hey. Don't say that.

If I am being honest to my calling as a member of the Nightguard...

...then I should be hunted down and finished.

Maybe it should be *you* who does it. Before I'm too far gone.

Do it!

Try a little harder, would you?

I told you about those vampire kids? Up north? They fought back. They stayed true to who they were.

#$%@ knows... I've fought plenty with the darkness inside of me.

Long as you can keep that hungry part of yourself caged, you can still do good.

Besides, monsters sometimes have the advantage...

...when fighting monsters!

FATHER COLE!

SNIKT

SNIKT

[00_best_]
[00_there]

[00_Reign]
[00___ofX]

WOLVERINE
[X_12]

BLOOD IN THE BANK

The Vampire Nation has been amassing power and resources under the leadership of Dracula. Among these resources: samples of Wolverine's blood, use of which allows the vamps to daywalk. Now Wolverine is out for blood. To take the fight directly to Drac, Wolverine sought out Louise, his friend in the vampire-hunting Nightguard -- but was stunned to find she seems to be becoming a vampire herself!

Meanwhile, Beast and X-Force have been tracking the mutant traitor Omega Red, who has been aiding Dracula in his plot...


Wolverine


Forge


Beast


Louise


Dracula


Omega Red

[ISSUE TWELVE]..... PENUMBRA

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[00_best_]
[00_there]

[00__is__]
[00_____]

[00_bub_]

[00____X]

[Wolverine]...Evidence]
[Blood].....log]

X-FORCE: EVIDENCE LOG

Notebook: Dr. James Boggs, Don of Microbiology, Oxford University

To say that the blood sample -- culled from the mutant known as Wolverine -- is abnormal would be an understatement. Its complexity is unguessable on a number of levels, and if I spent the next ten years studying it, I don't know that I would --

But what am I even saying? I don't have ten years. I don't know that I have ten days. And Timothy...poor Timothy... I daresay he might not last another ten hours.

Help me.

The antigen structure is unlike any other I've encountered. If a normal blood cell is a cardboard box -- simple, flexible, but sturdy in its structure -- Wolverine's is a brick house of many rooms and hallways with a fireplace roaring at its center.

I can hear him. Always. Whispering in my ear. Dracul.

Disease- and temperature-resistant, the muscular antibodies aggressively stand up to and wipe out any foreign intrusion. The exogenous polypeptides defy categorization. The hemoglobin count is an astonishing 30 grams per deciliter, so that one could say he is carrying around in his veins a nuclear arsenal of protein.

I see him in the mist oozing across the campus green, in the rat scurrying through the alley, in the bat clinging to an attic rafter. Dracul. His name is my command.

If only I could study the source himself, if only I could sample his bone marrow, things might be different. The answer -- to what some might call a veritable fountain of youth -- is in his stem cells.

Help me.

The lifespan of a standard red blood cell is 120 days. The lifespan of a vampire's is roughly one day. Whatever power comes with their virulence weakens the RBC membrane. The swift degradation of hemoglobin requires constant transfusion. A kind of daily dialysis. Thus their permanent thirst. They have to refresh their systems or they will collapse.

I saw a fly on a windowsill earlier today. I snatched it and shoved it in my mouth before I knew what I was doing.

An infusion of Wolverine's blood controls the standard antagonistic effects of phosphatidylserine, CD47, infrared, visible, and ultraviolet light. And the bloodclocks manage to replicate -- poorly but serviceably enough -- the liver and spleen, creating a sustainable environment, prolonging the healing factor's potential.

He's going to kill me soon. Please, God, forgive me for helping him.

—

I'm no cheerleader.

But she needs to realize that if you look at all my yesterdays...

...if you look at all the times I've lost control...

...if you look at the bad blood I've spilled...

...it's made me try that much ***harder*** to do the right thing today...

And by the right thing...

SCREEEE

...I of course mean stab the ones that deserve stabbing.

She's still got a choice and a chance to be one of the good guys.

That's enough, Louise.

Listen to me.

Because my voice...is an echo of the voice...already whispering inside you.

Yes. Yes, that's right. You hear *him*.

He's in you. He's in all of us.

Dracul.

I'm here to invite you to join the *new* Nightguard.

Help me secure Wolverine, and you will be rewarded.

No. Get out of my head.

Listen up, bub.

Notre Dame translates to *our lady.*

And our lady ain't happy.

CRACK

"Please. Please make it stop."

Make him be quiet.

He won't stop whispering, Dr. Boggs.

Oxford University.

And he's telling me...

...to drink!

Trust that I'm going to do everything I can to remedy what's happened, Timothy.

After Dracula came to me... after he demanded I help him develop a blood serum...

...I should have assigned you to a different lab.

It was selfish of me. I couldn't do the work without your help.

Here it comes...just a little bite.

Just a little *bite!*

HASSSSS!

Agggh!

Dracula told me about the work you're doing here.

Stop-- please--

Who are you?

He also told me that he plans to eat your heart like an apple when this is all over.

I can't pretend to be surprised.

Then why are you doing this? Why help Dracula if you know you're as good as dead?

I first agreed to help... because I'm a coward.

But now... I have to save him, even if I can't save myself.

What if I told you...

...you could do both?

What if there was another way?

A way we could help each other?

The Armory. Krakoa.

I brought Louise to Krakoa, to the Healing Gardens.

But Dr. Reyes said there was nothing she could do. Not with medicine, not with a transfusion.

She said she wished she could wrap a force-field around Louise and keep her safe.

And that gave me an idea.

You must really give a $#%& about this one.

We both want the same thing.

Oh, I bet you do.

How do I look?

You look like you're wearing a brilliantly constructed ***sunblock bio-suit*** lined with a ***porous bone marrow*** that helps generate blood cells, slowing your need to feed.

And let's not forget the accessories...

...including this UV-laced sword that should carve the worm-infested liver out of any vamp.

Top that off with a helmet...

SHUNK

...and you're basically a walking, talking battle coffin.

Your giant head doesn't need any inflating, but nice work, Forge.

Merci beaucoup.

Er... watch the neck.

Now that we've been clothes shopping, shall we go out for a night on the town?

There is a hive in Berlin I've been wanting to burn to the ground.

Wolverine, this is Sage.

Report to the Pointe immediately.

The Pointe.

Logan...if X-Force is the mutant C.I.A., then maybe I shouldn't come with, no?

You can't trust that I can be trusted.

We're shady at best.

So you'll fit right in with all the other ass--

--assassins? Is that what you were going to say?

The #%@& is *he* doing here?

SNIKT

Omega Red has a proposal for us.

I'd say you should have a seat... but outside of a bar-stool, you always seem to prefer to loom menacingly.

Whatever he pitches is a lie.

The Vampire Nation owns me.

All right... you got my attention.

Keep talking.

SNAKT

You do realize we could put you in the hole for what you've told us.

I'm already living in a hole. You want to keep me in the shadows.

If the island truly *gives*, as you say...then I want to be a part of it-- and give back.

But if I give back, I need you all to make good on your promise of amnesty.

Let me be my own mutant.

Can't help but suspect you're gaming us. But what's your move, Red? Spit it out.

The move is yours actually.

Dracula wants *you*.

So let's give him what he wants.

The catacombs of Paris. A few days later...

We've lived in the shadows long enough.

I was the first experiment.

A taste of his blood allowed me to walk in full sunlight for a day.

Then I developed the ***bloodclocks***, a portable transfusion device that preserved and pulsed out blood cells.

And with another sample from Wolverine, I shared the gift of daywalking with others.

I took these risks--

--daring the sun and the wrath of the mutant nation--

--in hopes of sharing this gift with you.

Now it's your turn.

Wolverine is ours.

And now, so is the day.

Soon, all of my children will have access to this privilege.

But for now, the *chosen* among us will have access to this private blood bank.

"This ain't right."

Earlier.

The Hatchery. Krakoa.

What exactly is wrong about it, Logan?

I'm so curious about your moral compass.

"Surely you don't object to killing. So it must be the moral quandary of editing life?

What's happening?

It hurts. It burns.

"Or maybe it's a dangerous but familiar reminder of your clones? Or...?"

It just ain't right.

SKELCH

NO...

Afraid so, bub.

Rest assured, the brain isn't functional except for the stem.

This is a purely reptilian specimen. Capable of little more than filling its lungs with oxygen.

"The serum Dr. Boggs was developing actually has great potential as a blood stabilizer.

"Maybe one day he'll develop a cure, after all."

But for now we're merely relying on the clone--and Omega Red--as vehicles for transmission.

The duplicate Wolverine has been gene-edited by the Five.

"Its blood is thick with photonic cells derived from plankton that produce their own luminescence.

"To put it in cruder terms..."

...we've made "you" into a dirty bomb.

There is more than one Wolverine...

And there is apparently more than one of you, Dr. Boggs.

You betrayed me.

SHLUNK

I thought your fear was too great to allow that.

The mutants...

...are scarier...

Only...

...time will tell...

...who is the greater monster.



[wolv__[0.12]
[erine_[0.12]

Not sure what I hate more:
vegetables, whiners, or
#@$% vampires.

-- WOLVERINE

[wolv__[0.XX]
[erine_[0.XX]



[wolv__[0.12].....]
[erine_[0.12].....]

[Wolverine_alpha.]

Later.
The Kingdom of Sevalith in the realm of Otherworld.

When we had it out with Arakko in the tournament...we learned some things.*

Sevalith might be the realm of the vampires, but they're not like *ours.*

*In the instant classic X of Swords crossover!
--Meta Mark

All the bloodsuckers on Earth, yourself included, come from the same inbred strain--Dracula's.

That's why he's in your head. He calls you his children, but really you're his slaves.

The vampires of Sevalith are more like royalty.

Sophisticated. Superior by design.

They aren't defined by their hunger, just like they aren't owned by one name.

They can even birth their own in blood wombs.

We go to them and we tell them that Dracula is building an army...

...they're going to consider him an insult to their kind, a rank beast humping the leg of immortality.

I humbly request your help in purging this coarse strain from the Earth.

If you're seeking an ally in *death*...

...you have come to the right place.

To be continued...

COMING SOON:



[kra_[0.0]...]
[koa_[0.0]...]

[00_wolverine_.12]

KRAKOA IS FOR ALL MUTANTS:

- HELLIONS #11:
- MARAUDERS #20:
- CHILDREN OF THE ATOM #3:
- X-CORP #1:
- X-FACTOR #9:
- WAY OF X #2:
- WOLVERINE #12:
- NEW MUTANTS #18:
- X-MEN #20:

[World_of_X [00.00]_X]
[World_of_X [00.00]_X]

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MY NAME IS JEAN GREY.

NOW...